Sport Consumer Emotions & Attributions

SPM381 CONSUMER BEHAVIOR IN SPORT

Why is consumer emotion important?

Inspiration

Motivation

Touching



https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=c-3XJozm6hQ

Why is consumer emotion important? Cont.

01 Consumption emotions has emerged as a key variable in sport consumer behavior and marketing.

02 Considered a strong determinant of satisfaction (Madrigal, 1995; Mano & Oliver, 1993), complaining behavior and word of mouth communications (Nyer, 1997), and consumer processing of advertisements (Luce, 1998).

03 In sport, Wann and colleagues (Wann & Branscombe, 1992; Wann, Dolan, McGeorge, & Allison, 1994) extended the scope of emotion research by investigating how sport consumers' levels of team identification influence their affective reactions subsequent to the game outcomes.

04 Sport consumers who experience positive consumption emotions tend to be passionate fans, advocates, and missionaries (Decrop & Derbaix, 2010).

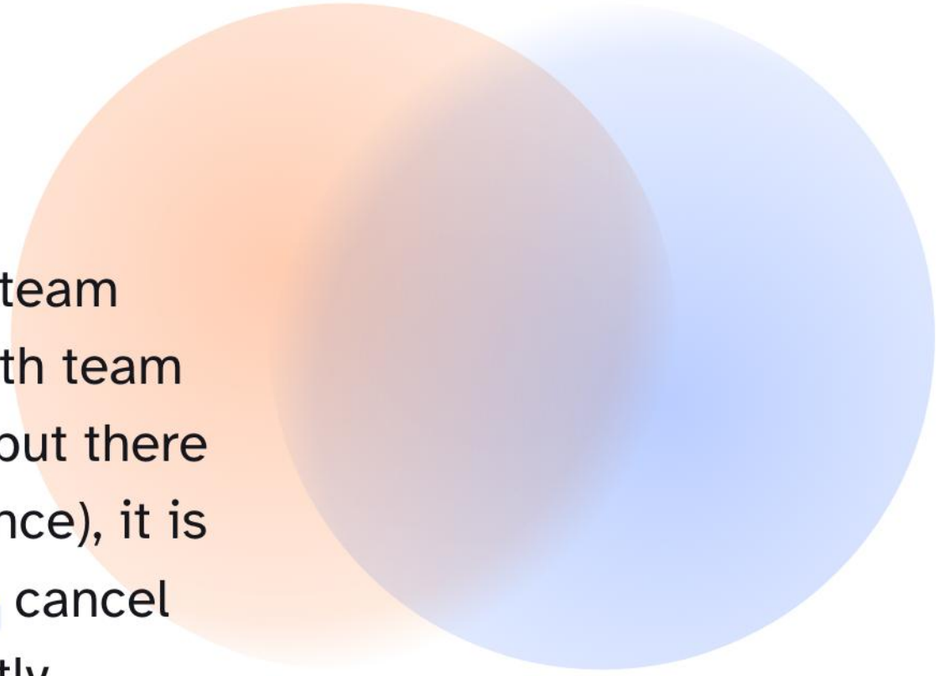
Why is consumer emotion important? Cont.

Sport consumers perceive a win by a favorite team as a positive game outcome, whereas they perceive a loss as a negative game outcome (Madrigal, 2003, 2008).

Because sport consumers who are attached to their favorite team perceive the team's win and lose as a **personal success** and **failure**.

Mixed emotions?

If a game result was a **disappointing win** (i.e., a team won, but there is some level of disappointment with team performance) or **relieving loss** (i.e., a team lost, but there is some level of appreciation with team performance), it is questionable whether **happy** and **sad (or anger)** cancel each other out or they can be experienced currently.



Can people feel mixed emotions?

Theories

First view

Cold  **Hot**

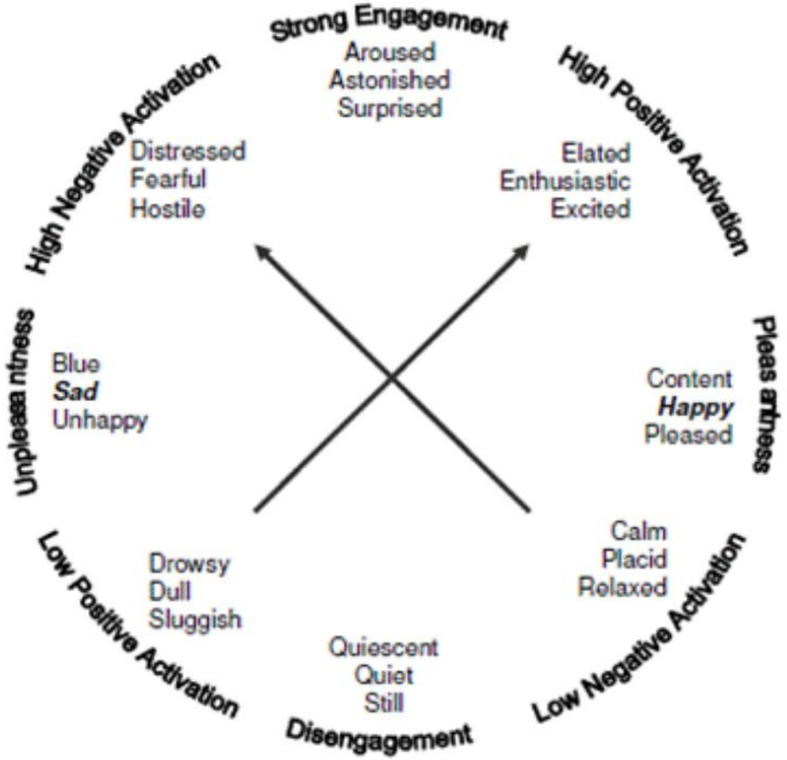
**An individual cannot feel extremely hot and cold at the same time.*

- Two perspectives on the affective system (Larsen & McGraw, 2011)
- Positive Activation/ Negative Activation (Watson & Tellegen, 1985)

Theories cont.

Positive Activation/ Negative Activation (Watson & Tellegen, 1985)

- Comprised of four bipolar dimensions:
- (1) positive affect (high positive activation v. low positive activation)
- (2) pleasantness (pleasantness v. unpleasantness)
- (3) negative affect (high negative activation v. low negative activation)
- (4) engagement (strong engagement v. disengagement)
- Happiness and sadness lie at opposite ends of a bipolar valence dimension (i.e., perfectly negatively correlated).
- Any increase in happiness comes with a commensurate decrease in sadness, and vice versa.



Theories cont.

Second view

Cold

Hot

**Positive and negative emotions are best characterized by two unipolar dimensions (i.e., separable).*

- Two perspectives on the affective system (Larsen & McGraw, 2011)
- Hunger and thirst, two different feelings, can be experienced at the same time.

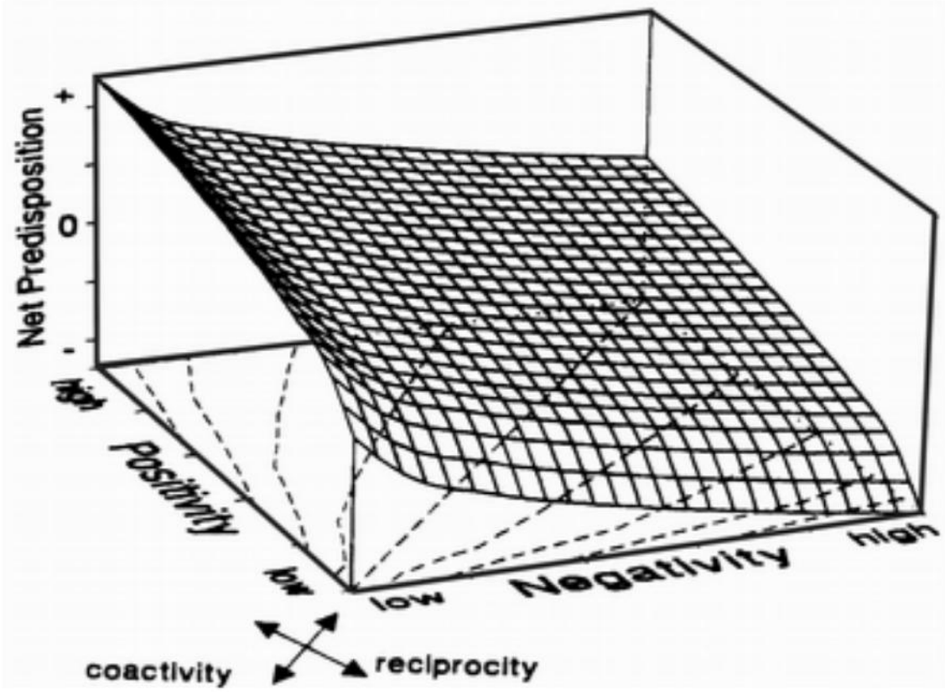




Theories cont.

Evaluative Space Model (Cacioppo & Berntson, 1994)

- No single structure to explain the human affect system.
- Emotions within the space of two valence dimensions (i.e., positive and negative) represent a more comprehensive formulation for illustrating the positive and negative activation.
- Affective reactions can be characterized any pattern of positivity and negativity.



Theories cont.

Evidence for mixed emotions

- In fact, most people react to everyday life by experiencing blends of emotions (Fong, 2006).











Theories cont.

Evidence for mixed emotions during consumption of a sporting event

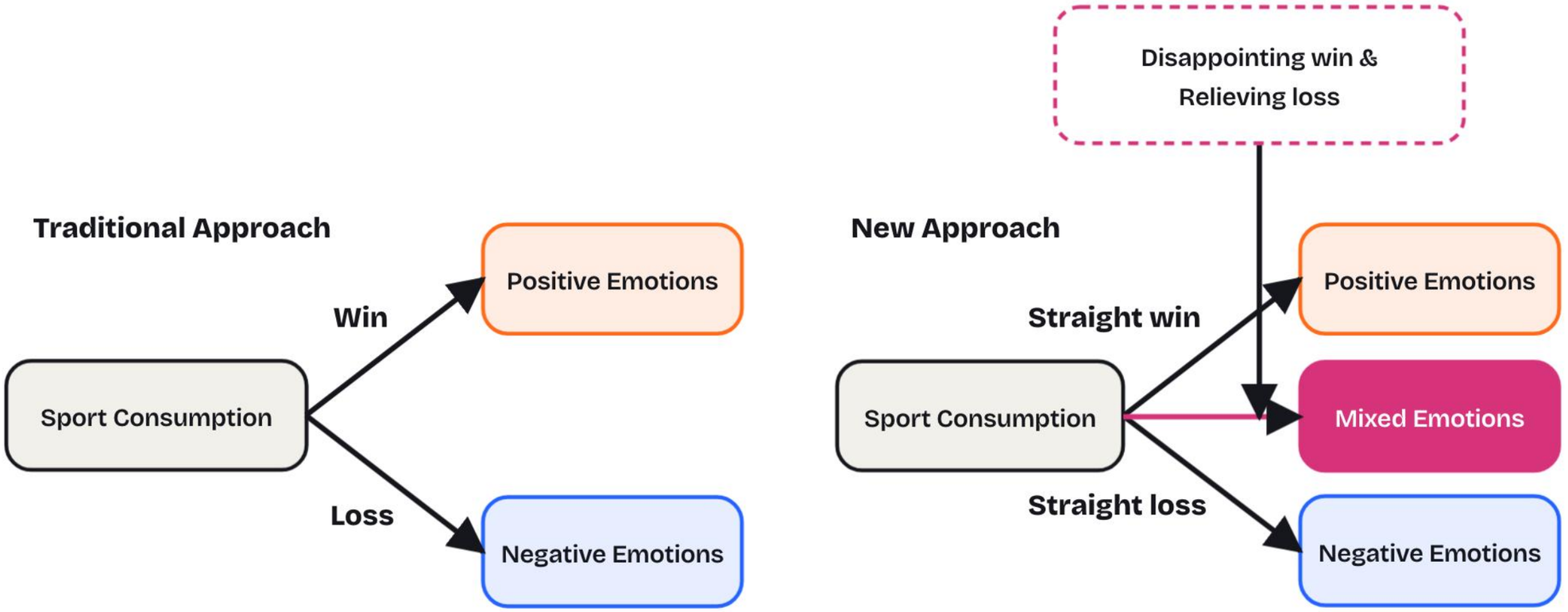
(Kim, James, & Kim, 2017)

- Disappointing Win (i.e., a team won, but there is some level of disappointment with the team performance).
- Relieving Loss (i.e., a team lost, but there is some level of appreciation with the team performance).





Theories cont.



Empirical Test

Pure sadness

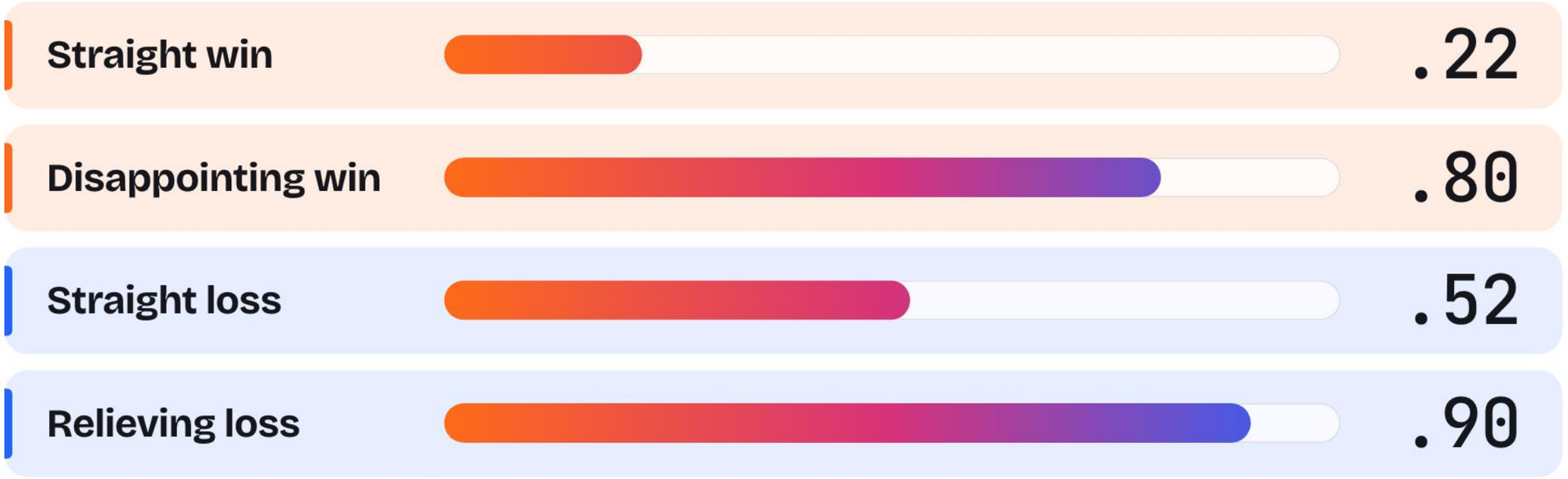
Mixed emotions

Pure happiness



Empirical Test cont.

MEAN RATINGS OF MIXED EMOTIONS

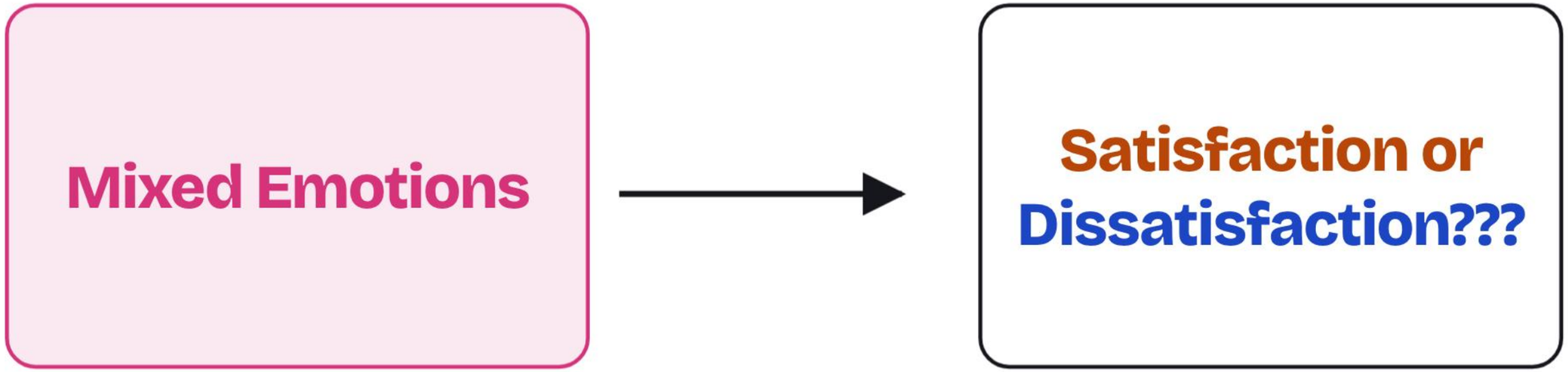


A consumer can experience mixed emotions during consumption of a sporting event.




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Mixed Emotions
Satisfaction or
Dissatisfaction???

PART II

Causal Attribution and Sport Consumer Emotions

Attribution & Emotion

What is attribution/attribution theory?

Quick evaluation:

01 **Positive or negative outcome?**

02 **Internal or external?**

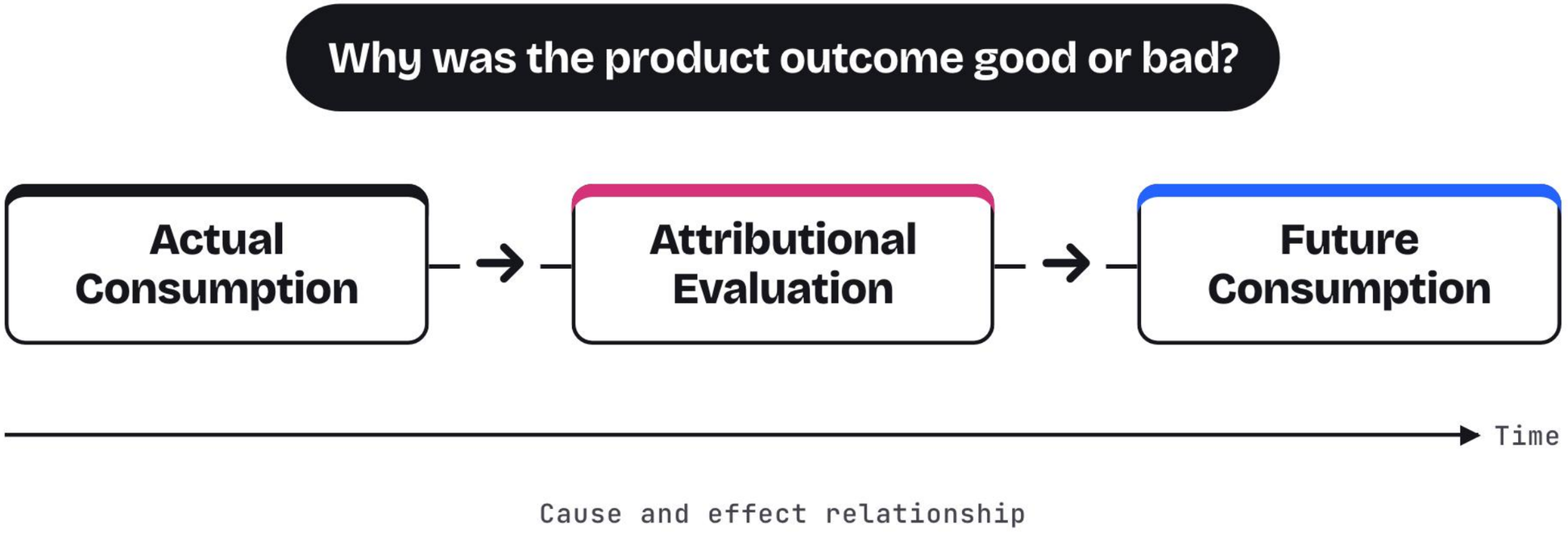
03 **Cause & effect?**



Attribution theory (Kelley, 1967; Weiner, 1985) has been widely used in social psychology and consumer behavior.

> **Attribution theory focuses upon the universal concern with explanation— "why a particular event or outcome has come about and the consequences of phenomenal causality"** (Folkes, 1984).

To buy or not to buy



Cause and effect relationship

Why?

Empirical research exploring the direct impact of attributions on consumption emotions in the field of sport consumer behavior is lacking.

01

Winning & Losing

02

Team Identification

Causal Attributions (Weiner, 1985, 1986)

01

Locus of Causality

Whether an outcome was due to internal causes (e.g., ability, effort)

02

Controllability

Whether an outcome was under the control of the individual or due to uncontrollable factors (e.g., luck)

03

Stability

Whether an outcome is due to a stable versus unstable cause and could have been anticipated.

See this week's discussion questions

01 Please apply the concept of each causal attribution dimension to the spectator sport context.

02 Please see this week's discussion questions

Causal Attributions in Sports (e.g., Dodgers)

01
Locus of Causality

02
Controllability

03
Stability



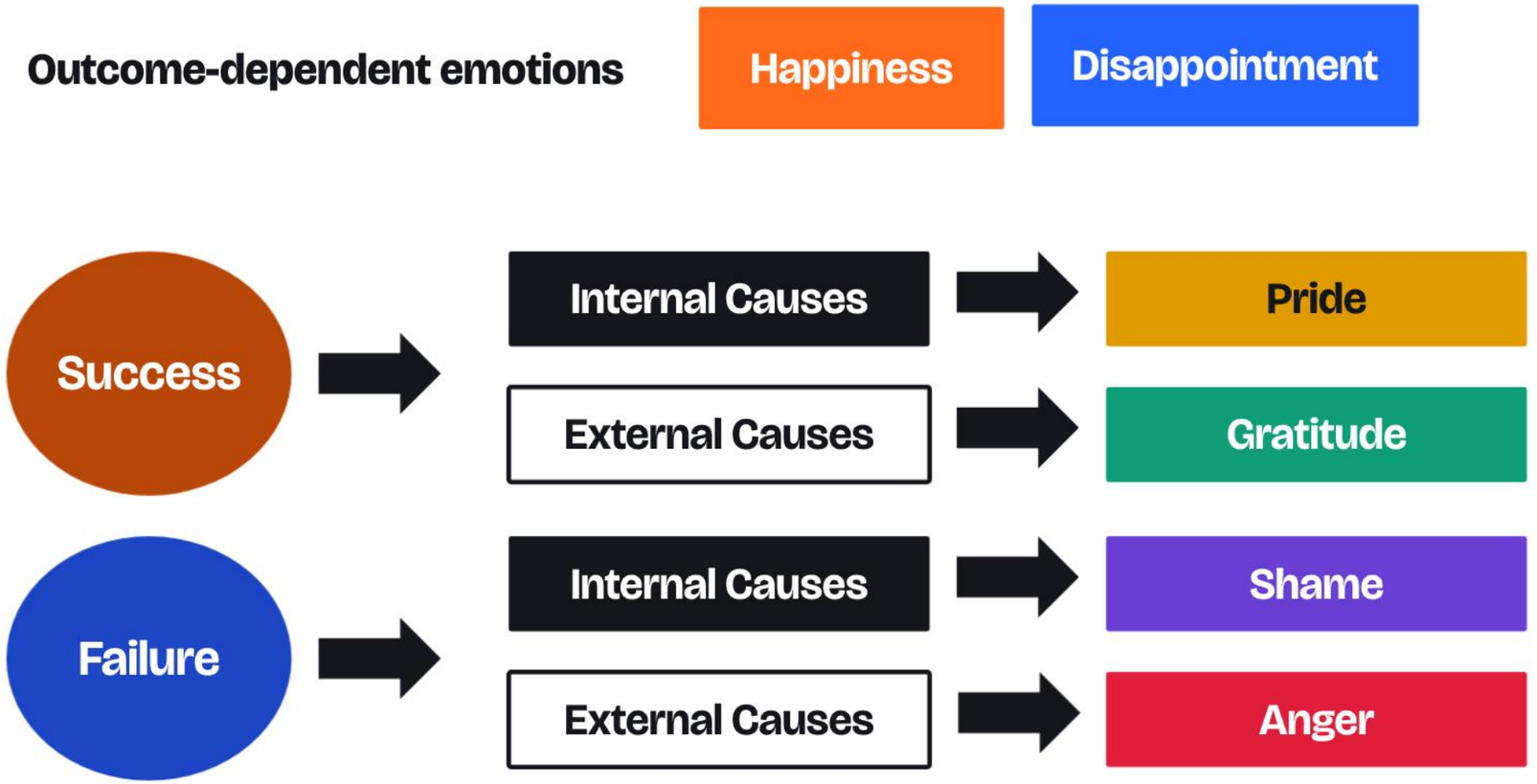
The Cognition—Emotion Process (Weiner, 1985)



Feelings arise from how an event is construed or evaluated.

Each dimension of attribution is uniquely related to a set of feelings.

Attributions—Emotion (Weiner,1985; Weiner, Russell, & Lerman, 1979)



Attributions—Emotion (Weiner,1985; Weiner, Russell, & Lerman, 1979)

Experiments

US Men's National Basketball Team vs. France (2024 Olympic Final)



https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=I7pTpMjqNRM

This is part of this week's discussion questions. Please see this week's discussion question #2.

01

When do sport consumers feel proud?

02

When do sport consumers feel grateful?

03

When do sport consumers feel shameful?

04

When do sport consumers feel angry?

Questions?